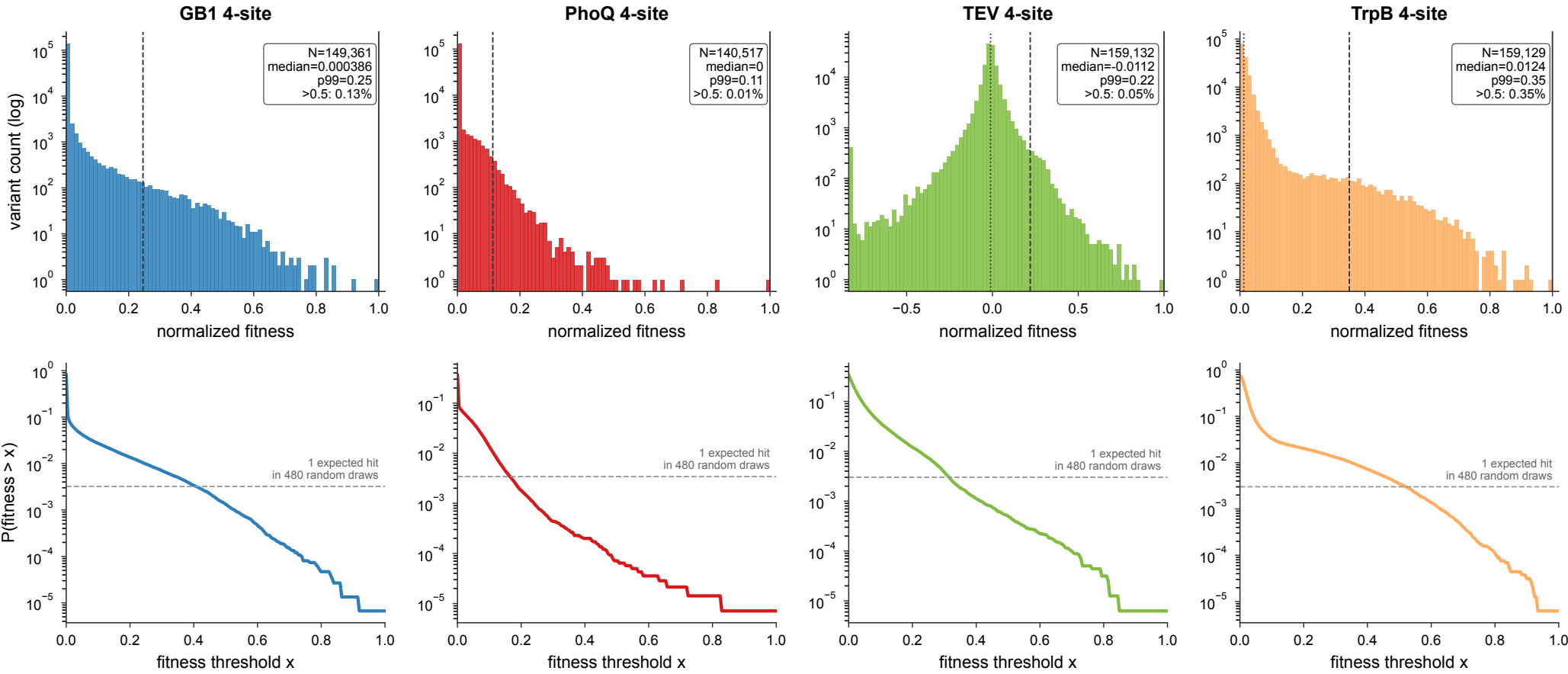


a**4-site landscape difficulty: fitness density (top) and survival $P(\text{fitness} > x)$ (bottom)**

All four landscapes are extreme needle-in-haystack: >90% of variants are near-dead; high-fitness mass is a thin tail. The dashed line marks the fitness a uniformly random 480-query budget can expect to reach.